

Why Learn AI?

Pretend you're a scribe in the year 1500. All day, you hand-copy the king's proclamations and send them out across the kingdom. Good work. Steady job. Then one morning, you hear that a guy in Mainz built a machine that prints pages a thousand times faster than you can write them. Two choices: pretend it isn't happening, or learn the new machine well enough to run it.

AI is the press. Run it, or someone else will.



AI IS EVERYWHERE

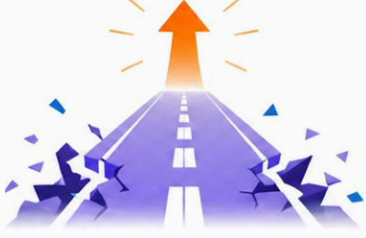
AI isn't something you go visit. It's already in the apps on your phone, the search results you read, and the tools your first job will hand you on day one. It feels like AI went from sci-fi to normal in about two years. **Most of what it does today, it will do better tomorrow.**

AI is already in the apps you use every day

 Recommends Predicts what you might like next. Spotify, Netflix, TikTok	 Navigation Predicts traffic and arrival time. Google Maps, Waze	 Face recognition Checks whether a face matches you. Phone unlock, photo tagging
 Voice assistants Turns your speech into words. Siri, Alexa, Hey Google	 Chatbots Carries on a conversation with you. ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini	

AND IT'S EARLY

Why you'll thrive in the AI future

1 THIS IS YOUR TIME Nobody has a twenty-year head start. That almost never happens with something this big. You're showing up right as it lands. 	2 YOU'LL MOVE FASTER AI collapses years of paying dues, learning the trade, and climbing the ladder. What took a decade is within reach now. 	3 NOTHING TO UNLEARN Others must undo the workflow that made them fast. You skip all of that and learn the new way from the start. 
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THIS HAS HAPPENED BEFORE

Before personal computers, becoming a designer meant years at a drafting table learning the craft by hand. Then desktop publishing showed up, and a teenager with a Mac could turn out professional work in an afternoon. The tool didn't replace skill, it shortened the distance between wanting to do the work and actually doing it. And it's the rule, not the exception: the steam engine did it for physical labor, electricity for the factory, the internet for information. **AI is that, for almost everything.**

And this isn't just tech industry hype. In July 2025, the White House released an official national strategy document, *Winning the Race: America's AI Action Plan*. Here's how it describes what AI makes possible:

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An industrial revolution, an information revolution, and a renaissance —all at once. This is the potential that AI presents.

— **WINNING THE RACE** · The White House, July 2025

AI is today's printing press.

Learn to run it.